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Social Studies Grade 3 (#5021050)

Version: 2024 - 2026

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Course Standards

Visit the specific benchmark webpage to find related instructional resources.

- [SS.3.A.1.1](#): Analyze primary and secondary sources.
- [SS.3.A.1.2](#): Utilize technology resources to gather information from primary and secondary sources.
- [SS.3.A.1.3](#): Define terms related to the social sciences.
- [SS.3.CG.1.1](#): Explain how the U.S. Constitution establishes the purpose and fulfills the need for government.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Students will explain the purpose of and need for government in terms of protection of rights, organization, security and services.

- [SS.3.CG.1.2](#): Describe how the U.S. government gains its power from the people.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Students will recognize what is meant by “We the People” and the phrase “consent of the governed.”

Clarification 2: Students will identify sources of consent (e.g., voting and elections).

Clarification 3: Students will recognize that the U.S. republic is governed by the “consent of the governed” and government power is exercised through representatives of the people.

- [SS.3.CG.2.1](#): Describe how citizens demonstrate civility, cooperation, volunteerism and other civic virtues.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Students will identify examples including, but not limited to, food drives, book drives, community clean-ups, voting, blood donation drives, volunteer fire departments and neighborhood watch programs.

- [SS.3.CG.2.2](#): Describe the importance of voting in elections.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Students will recognize that it is every citizen’s responsibility to vote.

Clarification 2: Students will explain the importance of voting in a republic.

- [SS.3.CG.2.3](#): Explain the history and meaning behind patriotic holidays and observances.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1:

Students will identify patriotic holidays and observances to include, but not limited to, American Founders Month, Celebrate Freedom Week, Constitution Day, Independence Day, Martin Luther King Jr. Day, Medal of Honor Day, Memorial Day, Patriot Day, and Veterans Day.

- [SS.3.CG.2.4](#): Recognize symbols, individuals, documents and events that represent the United States.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Students will recognize Mount Rushmore, Uncle Sam and the Washington Monument as symbols that represent the United States.

Clarification 2: Students will recognize James Madison, Alexander Hamilton, Booker T. Washington and Susan B. Anthony as individuals who represent the United States.

Clarification 3: Students will recognize the U.S. Constitution as a document that represents the United States.

Clarification 4: Students will recognize the Constitutional Convention (May 1787 – September 1787) and the signing of the U.S. Constitution (September 17, 1787) as events that represent the United States.

- [SS.3.CG.2.5:](#) Recognize symbols, individuals, documents and events that represent the State of Florida.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Students will recognize the Great Seal of the State of Florida as a symbol that represents the state.

Clarification 2: Students will recognize William Pope Duval, William Dunn Moseley and Josiah T. Walls as individuals who represent Florida.

Clarification 3: Students will identify the Declaration of Rights in the Florida Constitution as a document that represents Florida.

Clarification 4: Students will recognize that Florida became the 27th state of the United States on March 3, 1845.

- [SS.3.CG.3.1:](#) Explain how the U.S. and Florida Constitutions establish the structure, function, powers and limits of government.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Students will recognize that the U.S. Constitution and the Florida Constitution establish the framework for national and state government.

Clarification 2: Students will recognize how government is organized at the national level (e.g., three branches of government).

Clarification 3: Students will provide examples of people who make and enforce rules and laws in the United States (e.g., congress and president) and Florida (e.g., state legislature and governor).

- [SS.3.CG.3.2:](#)

Recognize that government has local, state, and national levels.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Students will recognize that each level of government has its own unique structure and responsibilities.

Clarification 2: Students will distinguish between the responsibilities of the local, state and national governments in the United States.

- [SS.3.E.1.1:](#) Give examples of how scarcity results in trade.
- [SS.3.E.1.2:](#) List the characteristics of money.
- [SS.3.E.1.3:](#) Recognize that buyers and sellers interact to exchange goods and services through the use of trade or money.
- [SS.3.E.1.4:](#) Distinguish between currencies used in the United States, Canada, Mexico, and the Caribbean.
- [SS.3.G.1.1:](#) Use thematic maps, tables, charts, graphs, and photos to analyze geographic information.
- [SS.3.G.1.2:](#) Review basic map elements (coordinate grid, cardinal and intermediate directions, title, compass rose, scale, key/legend with symbols) .
- [SS.3.G.1.3:](#) Label the continents and oceans on a world map.
- [SS.3.G.1.4:](#) Name and identify the purpose of maps (physical, political, elevation, population).
- [SS.3.G.1.5:](#) Compare maps and globes to develop an understanding of the concept of distortion.
- [SS.3.G.1.6:](#) Use maps to identify different types of scale to measure distances between two places.
- [SS.3.G.2.1:](#) Label the countries and commonwealths in North America (Canada, United States, Mexico) and in the Caribbean (Puerto Rico, Cuba, Bahamas, Dominican Republic, Haiti, Jamaica).
- [SS.3.G.2.2:](#) Identify the five regions of the United States.
- [SS.3.G.2.3:](#) Label the states in each of the five regions of the United States.
- [SS.3.G.2.4:](#) Describe the physical features of the United States, Canada, Mexico, and the Caribbean.
- [SS.3.G.2.5:](#) Identify natural and man-made landmarks in the United States, Canada, Mexico, and the Caribbean.
- [SS.3.G.2.6:](#) Investigate how people perceive places and regions differently by conducting interviews, mental mapping, and studying news, poems, legends, and songs about a region or area.
- [SS.3.G.3.1:](#) Describe the climate and vegetation in the United States, Canada, Mexico, and the Caribbean.

- [SS.3.G.3.2](#): Describe the natural resources in the United States, Canada, Mexico, and the Caribbean.
- [SS.3.G.4.1](#): Explain how the environment influences settlement patterns in the United States, Canada, Mexico, and the Caribbean.
- [SS.3.G.4.2](#): Identify the cultures that have settled the United States, Canada, Mexico, and the Caribbean.
- [SS.3.G.4.3](#): Compare the cultural characteristics of diverse populations in one of the five regions of the United States with Canada, Mexico, or the Caribbean.
- [SS.3.G.4.4](#): Identify contributions from various ethnic groups to the United States.
- [MA.K12.MTR.1.1](#): **Actively participate in effortful learning both individually and collectively.**

Mathematicians who participate in effortful learning both individually and with others:

- Analyze the problem in a way that makes sense given the task.
- Ask questions that will help with solving the task.
- Build perseverance by modifying methods as needed while solving a challenging task.
- Stay engaged and maintain a positive mindset when working to solve tasks.
- Help and support each other when attempting a new method or approach.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to participate actively in effortful learning both individually and with others:

- Cultivate a community of growth mindset learners.
- Foster perseverance in students by choosing tasks that are challenging.
- Develop students' ability to analyze and problem solve.
- Recognize students' effort when solving challenging problems.
- [MA.K12.MTR.2.1](#): **Demonstrate understanding by representing problems in multiple ways.**

Mathematicians who demonstrate understanding by representing problems in multiple ways:

- Build understanding through modeling and using manipulatives.
- Represent solutions to problems in multiple ways using objects, drawings, tables, graphs and equations.
- Progress from modeling problems with objects and drawings to using algorithms and equations.
- Express connections between concepts and representations.
- Choose a representation based on the given context or purpose.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to demonstrate understanding by representing problems in multiple ways:

- Help students make connections between concepts and representations.
- Provide opportunities for students to use manipulatives when investigating concepts.
- Guide students from concrete to pictorial to abstract representations as understanding progresses.
- Show students that various representations can have different purposes and can be useful in different situations.

• **MA.K12.MTR.3.1: Complete tasks with mathematical fluency.**

Mathematicians who complete tasks with mathematical fluency:

- Select efficient and appropriate methods for solving problems within the given context.
- Maintain flexibility and accuracy while performing procedures and mental calculations.
- Complete tasks accurately and with confidence.
- Adapt procedures to apply them to a new context.
- Use feedback to improve efficiency when performing calculations.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to complete tasks with mathematical fluency:

- Provide students with the flexibility to solve problems by selecting a procedure that allows them to solve efficiently and accurately.
 - Offer multiple opportunities for students to practice efficient and generalizable methods.
 - Provide opportunities for students to reflect on the method they used and determine if a more efficient method could have been used.
- **MA.K12.MTR.4.1: Engage in discussions that reflect on the mathematical thinking of self and others.**

Mathematicians who engage in discussions that reflect on the mathematical thinking of self and others:

- Communicate mathematical ideas, vocabulary and methods effectively.
- Analyze the mathematical thinking of others.
- Compare the efficiency of a method to those expressed by others.
- Recognize errors and suggest how to correctly solve the task.
- Justify results by explaining methods and processes.
- Construct possible arguments based on evidence.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to engage in discussions that reflect on the mathematical thinking of self and others:

- Establish a culture in which students ask questions of the teacher and their peers, and error is an opportunity for learning.
 - Create opportunities for students to discuss their thinking with peers.
 - Select, sequence and present student work to advance and deepen understanding of correct and increasingly efficient methods.
 - Develop students' ability to justify methods and compare their responses to the responses of their peers.
- **MA.K12.MTR.5.1: Use patterns and structure to help understand and connect mathematical concepts.**

Mathematicians who use patterns and structure to help understand and connect mathematical concepts:

- Focus on relevant details within a problem.
- Create plans and procedures to logically order events, steps or ideas to solve problems.
- Decompose a complex problem into manageable parts.
- Relate previously learned concepts to new concepts.
- Look for similarities among problems.
- Connect solutions of problems to more complicated large-scale situations.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to use patterns and structure to help understand and connect mathematical concepts:

- Help students recognize the patterns in the world around them and connect these patterns to mathematical concepts.
- Support students to develop generalizations based on the similarities found among problems.
- Provide opportunities for students to create plans and procedures to solve problems.
- Develop students' ability to construct relationships between their current understanding and more sophisticated ways of thinking.

• **MA.K12.MTR.6.1: Assess the reasonableness of solutions.**

Mathematicians who assess the reasonableness of solutions:

- Estimate to discover possible solutions.
- Use benchmark quantities to determine if a solution makes sense.
- Check calculations when solving problems.
- Verify possible solutions by explaining the methods used.
- Evaluate results based on the given context.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to assess the reasonableness of solutions:

- Have students estimate or predict solutions prior to solving.
- Prompt students to continually ask, "Does this solution make sense? How do you know?"
- Reinforce that students check their work as they progress within and after a task.

- Strengthen students' ability to verify solutions through justifications.

- **MA.K12.MTR.7.1: Apply mathematics to real-world contexts.**

Mathematicians who apply mathematics to real-world contexts:

- Connect mathematical concepts to everyday experiences.
- Use models and methods to understand, represent and solve problems.
- Perform investigations to gather data or determine if a method is appropriate.
- Redesign models and methods to improve accuracy or efficiency.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to apply mathematics to real-world contexts:

- Provide opportunities for students to create models, both concrete and abstract, and perform investigations.
- Challenge students to question the accuracy of their models and methods.
- Support students as they validate conclusions by comparing them to the given situation.
- Indicate how various concepts can be applied to other disciplines.

- **ELA.K12.EE.1.1**: Cite evidence to explain and justify reasoning.

Clarifications:

K-1 Students include textual evidence in their oral communication with guidance and support from adults. The evidence can consist of details from the text without naming the text. During 1st grade, students learn how to incorporate the evidence in their writing.

2-3 Students include relevant textual evidence in their written and oral communication. Students should name the text when they refer to it. In 3rd grade, students should use a combination of direct and indirect citations.

4-5 Students continue with previous skills and reference comments made by speakers and peers. Students cite texts that they've directly quoted, paraphrased, or used for information. When writing, students will use the form of citation dictated by the instructor or the style guide referenced by the instructor.

6-8 Students continue with previous skills and use a style guide to create a proper citation.

9-12 Students continue with previous skills and should be aware of existing style guides and the ways in which they differ.

- [ELA.K12.EE.2.1](#): Read and comprehend grade-level complex texts proficiently.

Clarifications:

See [Text Complexity](#) for grade-level complexity bands and a text complexity rubric.

- [ELA.K12.EE.3.1](#): Make inferences to support comprehension.

Clarifications:

Students will make inferences before the words infer or inference are introduced. Kindergarten students will answer questions like “Why is the girl smiling?” or make predictions about what will happen based on the title page. Students will use the terms and apply them in 2nd grade and beyond.

- [ELA.K12.EE.4.1](#): Use appropriate collaborative techniques and active listening skills when engaging in discussions in a variety of situations.

Clarifications:

In kindergarten, students learn to listen to one another respectfully.

In grades 1-2, students build upon these skills by justifying what they are thinking. For example: “I think _____ because _____.” The collaborative conversations are becoming academic conversations.

In grades 3-12, students engage in academic conversations discussing claims and justifying their reasoning, refining and applying skills. Students build on ideas, propel the conversation, and support claims and counterclaims with evidence.

- [ELA.K12.EE.5.1](#): Use the accepted rules governing a specific format to create quality work.

Clarifications:

Students will incorporate skills learned into work products to produce quality work. For students to incorporate these skills appropriately, they must receive instruction. A 3rd grade student creating a poster board display must have instruction in how to effectively present information to do quality work.

- [ELA.K12.EE.6.1](#): Use appropriate voice and tone when speaking or writing.

Clarifications:

In kindergarten and 1st grade, students learn the difference between formal and informal language. For example, the way we talk to our friends differs from the way we speak to adults. In 2nd grade and beyond, students practice appropriate social and academic language to discuss texts.

- [ELD.K12.ELL.SI.1](#): English language learners communicate for social and instructional purposes within the school setting.
- [ELD.K12.ELL.SS.1](#): English language learners communicate information, ideas and concepts necessary for academic success in the content area of Social Studies.
- [HE.3.C.2.3 \(Archived Standard\)](#): Identify classroom and school rules that promote health and disease prevention.

Course Information

General Notes

Third Grade: The United States Regions and Its Neighbors - The third grade Social Studies curriculum consists of the following content area strands: American History, Geography, Economics, and Civics. Third grade students will learn about North America and the Caribbean. They will focus on the regions of the United States, Canada, Mexico, and the Caribbean Islands. Their study will include physical and cultural characteristics as they learn about our country and its neighbors.

Instructional Practices

Teaching from well-written, grade-level instructional materials enhances students' content area knowledge and also strengthens their ability to comprehend longer, complex reading passages on any topic for any reason. Using the following instructional practices also helps student learning:

1. Reading assignments from longer text passages as well as shorter ones when text is extremely complex.
2. Making close reading and rereading of texts central to lessons.
3. Asking high-level, text-specific questions and requiring high-level, complex tasks and assignments.

4. Requiring students to support answers with evidence from the text.
5. Providing extensive text-based research and writing opportunities (claims and evidence).

Florida's Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking (B.E.S.T.) Standards

This course includes Florida's B.E.S.T. ELA Expectations (EE) and Mathematical Thinking and Reasoning Standards (MTRs) for students. Florida educators should intentionally embed these standards within the content and their instruction as applicable. For guidance on the implementation of the EEs and MTRs, please visit https://www.cpalms.org/Standards/BEST_Standards.aspx and select the appropriate B.E.S.T. Standards package.

English Language Development ELD Standards Special Notes Section:

Teachers are required to provide listening, speaking, reading and writing instruction that allows English language learners (ELL) to communicate information, ideas and concepts for academic success in the content area of Social Studies. For the given level of English language proficiency and with visual, graphic, or interactive support, students will interact with grade level words, expressions, sentences and discourse to process or produce language necessary for academic success. The ELD standard should specify a relevant content area concept or topic of study chosen by curriculum developers and teachers which maximizes an ELL's need for communication and social skills. To access an ELL supporting document which delineates performance definitions and descriptors, please click on the following link:

https://cpalmsmediaproduct.blob.core.windows.net/uploads/docs/standard_s/eld/ss.pdf

General Information

Course Number: 5021050

Course Path: Section: Grades PreK to 12 Education Courses >

Grade Group: Grades PreK to 5 Education Courses > **Subject:** Social Studies > **SubSubject:** General >

Abbreviated Title: SOC STUDIES 3

Course Length: Year (Y)

Course Attributes:

- Class Size Core Required

Course Type: Core Academic Course
Course Status: Course Approved
Grade Level(s): 3

Educator Certifications

One of these educator certification options is required to teach this course.

- [Elementary Education \(Elementary Grades 1-6\)](#)
- [Social Studies \(Elementary Grades 1-6\)](#)
- [Primary Education \(K-3 - No Longer Issued\)](#)
- [Prekindergarten/Primary Education \(Age 3 through Grade 3\)](#)
- [Elementary Education \(Grades K-6\)](#)
- [Classical Education - Restricted \(Elementary and Secondary Grades K-12\)](#)

Section 1012.55(5), F.S., authorizes the issuance of a classical education teaching certificate, upon the request of a classical school, to any applicant who fulfills the requirements of s. 1012.56(2)(a)-(f) and (11), F.S., and Rule 6A-4.004, F.A.C. Classical schools must meet the requirements outlined in s. 1012.55(5), F.S., and be listed in the [FLDOE Master School ID](#) database, to request a restricted classical education teaching certificate on behalf of an applicant.